



University edtech audit: compare your app against 1EdTech TrustEd Apps certification rubrics, LTI interoperability, and EDUCAUSE 2026 security standards

Computer

Higher-ed feature roadmap: build an institutional feature matrix addressing 2026 EDUCAUSE priorities like AI literacy, role-based governance, and WCAG accessibility

Computer

Show me how to approach IT compliance

How do we pass 1EdTech and security audits

Outline a faculty change-management playbook

To win university IT trust, treat compliance as a **continuous evidence system**, not a one-time security questionnaire. The practical path is: build controls into the platform, maintain proof that those controls operate, map the proof to HECVAT and 1EdTech rubrics, and make the material easy for IT, security, accessibility, privacy, and procurement teams to review.

HECVAT is widely used in higher education as a standardized vendor-assessment questionnaire spanning cybersecurity, privacy, IT accessibility, and compliance; it is not itself a certification.

[1] [2] [3]

IT compliance approach

1. Build a compliance operating model

Create a **Trust, Risk, and Compliance** program with named owners—not a folder of policy PDFs.

Executive sponsor:

Accountable for risk appetite, budget, major exceptions, and customer trust.

Security lead:

Owns security controls, risk register, access reviews, incident readiness, vulnerability management, and technical evidence.

Privacy lead:

Owns data inventory, legal/contractual data-use requirements, retention, data-subject/student requests, subprocessors, and FERPA/DPA alignment.

Accessibility lead:

Owns accessibility acceptance criteria, testing, remediation, ACR/VPAT, and accessible-content processes.

AI governance lead:

Owns AI inventory, provider approvals, evaluations, policy configuration, safety incidents, model/provider change review, and transparency.

Engineering lead:

Owns secure development, architecture, environments, deployment controls, monitoring, backup/recovery, and remediation.

Customer trust owner:

Owns procurement room, security-questionnaire responses, evidence freshness, customer-facing trust communication, and contractual commitment mapping.

2. Maintain a control-and-evidence register

For every control, track:

Control ID

Framework mapping: HECVAT / 1EdTech / SOC 2 / ISO 27001 / NIST / internal

Risk addressed

Control description

Owner

System/process in scope

Frequency

Evidence type

Evidence link/location

Last tested date

Result

Open exception

Remediation owner

Target date

Next review date

Customer-facing claim supported

Example:

Control	Evidence	Frequency	Owner
Production access review	Exported role/access review plus approval record	Quarterly	Security lead
Backup restore test	Restore log, recovery-time result, issue record	Quarterly	Engineering lead
AI provider review	Vendor terms, DPA, retention/training position, risk assessment	Before enablement and annually	AI/privacy lead
Accessibility release gate	Automated scan, manual test, issue disposition	Every release	Accessibility/engineering lead
Subprocessor review	Inventory, DPA/security review, change notice record	Before use and annually	Privacy lead
Incident exercise	Tabletop scenario, attendance, findings, actions	At least annually	Security lead

3. Build a procurement evidence room

Trust Center public pages:

Privacy

Security overview

Accessibility statement

AI transparency

Subprocessors

System status

Responsible disclosure

Secure procurement room:

HECVAT

Architecture overview/data-flow diagrams

Penetration-test executive summary, if available

Security policies

DPA

Standard contract positions

Incident-response overview

Business continuity/disaster recovery overview

Accessibility ACR/VPAT

AI governance package

LTI/OneRoster/SSO/SCIM documentation

Retention/export/offboarding guide

Insurance certificates, if applicable

Customer-specific integration/data map

Give every artifact:

Owner

Version

Issue date

Review date

Expiry date

Approval status

Customer visibility

Related framework controls

Passing 1EdTech review

1EdTech strategy

Do not claim “1EdTech certified” until the exact certification is awarded. Build in this order:

Join/participate

→ adopt relevant standards

→ complete internal readiness assessment

→ document public policies accurately

→ validate implementation and evidence

→ pursue interoperability certification(s)

- pursue TrustEd Apps privacy/security/accessibility review as applicable
- maintain recertification/change process

1EdTech's TrustEd Apps program combines open-standards and privacy commitments with app vetting/certification resources. Its accessibility rubric assesses a supplier's approach to accessible and equitable access, including conformance documentation and certification evidence. ^[1676]^[1675]

1EdTech readiness checklist

Interoperability

- [] LTI 1.3 Core implemented and tested.
- [] LTI Advantage services implemented only where product use cases require them: Deep Linking, NRPS, AGS.
- [] OneRoster implemented for authorized roster/course exchange.
- [] QTI 3 used for portable assessment content.
- [] CASE considered only when competency/outcome workflows are mature.
- [] Open Badges/CLR considered only when credential issuance/evidence is real.
- [] Standards version support is published.
- [] Synthetic sandbox and conformance test environment exists.
- [] Integration guides include fields, direction, scope, error handling, rate behavior, customer configuration, and offboarding.
- [] No unsupported interoperability claims appear in marketing or sales materials.

Data privacy

- [] Privacy policy accurately describes collection, use, sharing, retention, deletion, cookies, advertising, AI, and user controls.
- [] Terms of service are public, current, and consistent with actual behavior.
- [] Data inventory identifies all student, institution, employee, and operational data.
- [] Data use is limited to defined purposes.
- [] No sale of student data.
- [] Advertising policy is explicit; no behavioral targeting based on sensitive, academic, support, or education-record data.
- [] Subprocessor list is public and maintained.
- [] Data-retention schedule and deletion/offboarding process are documented.
- [] Role-based access and support access controls are enforced and logged.
- [] Data export/correction/deletion request mechanisms are operational.
- [] AI training/provider-data-use policy is public and technically enforced.
- [] Security, privacy, accessibility, and AI contacts are published.

Security practices

- [] SSO, MFA for privileged users, session management, and access review exist.
- [] Secrets are stored in managed secret storage, rotated, and never exposed in code.
- [] Encryption in transit and at rest is implemented and documented.
- [] Production and non-production environments are separated.
- [] Production student data is prohibited from ordinary development/testing.

- [] Vulnerability scanning, patching, dependency management, and penetration testing
- [] Secure SDLC includes code review, security testing, change approval, and deployment
- [] Centralized logging, alerting, and incident response are operational.
- [] Backup, recovery, restore testing, and business-continuity plans exist.
- [] Vendor/subprocessor security review is documented.
- [] Staff security/privacy training and offboarding controls are evidenced.
- [] Vulnerability disclosure and incident-notification processes are published.

Accessibility

- [] WCAG 2.2 AA target is documented.
- [] Accessibility is part of design, development, QA, release, and procurement.
- [] Keyboard, screen-reader, zoom/reflow, mobile, contrast, captions, transcripts, accessible math, tables, charts, forms, and documents are tested.
- [] Student, faculty, admin, customer portal, and Operations Console workflows are in
- [] AI-generated content has accessibility checks and does not claim certification at
- [] Accessibility issue intake, priority, remediation, and customer communication wor
- [] ACR/VPAT is current, evidence-backed, and has known limitations disclosed.
- [] Accessibility testing includes disabled users/assistive technologies where feasi

Evidence that makes audits easy

Area	Strong evidence	Weak evidence
Access control	Quarterly review export, approvals, corrective actions	“We use RBAC” in a policy
Encryption	Architecture diagram, configuration evidence, key-management process	Generic website statement
Incident response	Runbook, tabletop results, corrective-action tracker	Untested incident policy
Backup/recovery	Restore test with RTO/RPO evidence	“Backups are enabled”
AI governance	Model inventory, evaluations, policy configuration, provider terms	“AI is responsible” statement
Accessibility	Current ACR/VPAT, manual-test evidence, open-issue tracker	Automated scan only
Privacy	Data map, retention tests, subprocessors, deletion evidence	Broad privacy policy
Interoperability	Sandbox/conformance output, customer test plan, integration guides	Logo strip of “integrations”

Security audit readiness

HECVAT preparation

Start with the current HECVAT version required by the target institution, then complete it from actual evidence—not aspirational roadmap statements.

1. Assign a response owner and evidence owner for every section.
2. Build an answer library that maps each response to a policy, configuration, test report, diagram, or operational record.
3. Identify “not applicable” answers and document why they genuinely do not apply.
4. Record compensating controls for partial gaps.
5. Maintain a remediation plan with dates and accountable owner.

6. Have security, privacy, accessibility, legal, engineering, and operations review :
7. Version-control the completed HECVAT and refresh it after material changes.
8. Never represent planned controls as implemented controls.

EDUCAUSE describes HECVAT as a community-built, comprehensive questionnaire intended to give institutions a detailed view of a vendor's cybersecurity, privacy, accessibility, and compliance standards.^[1]

Baseline security audit checklist

Governance

- [] Security policy suite approved and reviewed annually.
- [] Risk register, risk owners, and risk-acceptance process exist.
- [] Asset inventory covers systems, data stores, integrations, code repositories, cloud accounts, endpoints, and vendors.
- [] Security awareness and role-specific training are tracked.

Identity and access

- [] SSO for workforce where possible.
- [] MFA for administrators, developers, support, and privileged access.
- [] Least privilege, periodic access reviews, and timely offboarding.
- [] Break-glass access controlled, logged, and reviewed.
- [] No shared privileged accounts.

Application and SDLC

- [] Threat modeling for high-risk features.
- [] Code review, branch protections, CI checks, secrets scanning, dependency scanning, and infrastructure-as-code review.
- [] Separate development, test, staging, and production environments.
- [] Change management, rollback plans, and production deployment audit trail.
- [] Security testing before major releases.

Data protection

- [] Data classification and data inventory.
- [] Encryption in transit and at rest.
- [] Backup encryption and restore tests.
- [] Retention, deletion, export, legal hold, and offboarding controls.
- [] Tenant isolation and authorization testing.
- [] DLP/redaction for logs, support, AI, and analytics where needed.

Operations

- [] Centralized logs and security alerting.
- [] Monitoring for authentication anomalies, privilege changes, sensitive-data access, integration failures, and unusual export activity.
- [] Incident-response plan, severity model, notification process, tabletop exercises, and post-incident process.
- [] Business continuity and disaster-recovery plan with tested RTO/RPO.
- [] Vulnerability-management SLA and patch evidence.

Third parties

- [] Subprocessor inventory, due diligence, contractual controls, and monitoring.
- [] AI provider/data-use assessment.

- [] Open-source license/dependency management.
- [] Vendor access uses least privilege, time bounds, and logging.

Collaborative cybersecurity and shared responsibility are a highlighted priority in EDUCAUSE's 2026 Top 10 framing, which is why Semester should make the customer's IT/security team a partner in configuration and evidence—not a late-stage approval gate. [¹⁶⁷⁴][1348]

Faculty change-management playbook

Faculty adoption is won through relevance, control, time savings, and credible support—not mandatory training alone.

Phase 1: Listen and map

Before building the rollout:

Identify faculty segments:

- Early adopters
- Course coordinators
- Adjunct/part-time faculty
- Large-enrollment instructors
- Online/hybrid instructors
- Accessibility champions
- Skeptical faculty
- Teaching assistants
- Department chairs

Map:

- Current LMS workflow
- Pain points
- Assessment workflow
- Content migration needs
- AI policy concerns
- Accessibility needs
- Support availability
- High-stakes dates
- Existing tools and contract commitments

Run short, compensated or properly recognized design sessions. Ask:

- What takes too long?
- What causes student confusion?
- Where do you duplicate work?
- What would make you distrust a new platform?
- What data should you never have to see?
- What should AI never do in your course?
- What would prove the platform saved you time?

Phase 2: Give faculty control

Faculty need controls without requiring them to become system administrators.

Course AI policy templates:

Not allowed / limited / allowed with disclosure / instructor-defined.

Assessment policy:

Practice, graded, open book, timed, accommodation-aware, late work, attempts, release rules.

Communication policy:

Announcement cadence, reminders, office-hours availability, notification preferences.

Content policy:

Source ownership, visibility, copyright/access expiry, reuse/import permissions.

Grading policy:

Rubrics, anonymous grading, TA role, moderation, release, appeal/regrade workflow.

Student-support policy:

Approved help routes and referral language.

Every policy should have:

Plain-language student preview

Version history

Effective date

Course-level override

Institutional baseline

Accessibility check

Export/printable view

Phase 3: Pilot, do not impose

Choose 3-8 representative courses.

Include varied disciplines, enrollment sizes, delivery modes, and accessibility needs.

Define a limited pilot scope:

Course Home

Assignment/work-completion workflow

Study Studio

Rubrics/feedback

One assessment type

Course AI policy

LTI integration, if relevant

Set non-negotiable success measures:

Faculty setup time
Student time-to-first-task
Assignment submission success
Feedback turnaround
Accessibility task completion
Support-ticket volume
Faculty/student trust rating
Integration accuracy

Do not start with the highest-stakes grading or the most complex course migration.

Phase 4: Enable through the work

Replace generic training with role- and moment-specific help.

Moment	Faculty support
Before term	Course migration clinic, syllabus review, AI-policy configuration, accessibility check
Week 1	Student onboarding scripts, announcements, office hours, enrollment/roster support
Before first assignment	Rubric builder, submission preview, grading practice, TA calibration
Before first assessment	Student-preview test, accommodation review, QTI/accessibility validation, contingency plan
During grading	Inline help, feedback templates, AI-assist disclosure, grade-release checklist
Midterm	Adoption review, student feedback, workload check, accessibility issue review
End of term	Grade export/reconciliation, archive, course reflection, next-term improvement plan

Phase 5: Build faculty champions

Faculty champion program:

- Department-nominated, compensated or formally recognized champions.
- Early access and structured feedback.
- Peer demonstrations using real, permissioned course examples.
- Office hours and migration clinics.
- Clear boundary: champions advise and demonstrate; they are not unpaid support staff
- Public “what changed because faculty said so” updates.

Phase 6: Measure and improve

Measure faculty value, not just logins.

Setup time per course
Time spent locating/creating materials
Assignment creation and grading time
Feedback turnaround
Number of repeated student questions
Accessibility issues caught before release
Student completion/error rate
Support escalation volume

AI-policy clarity
Faculty confidence and willingness to continue

Faculty communications

Use direct, honest language:

Semester will not replace your academic judgment.
AI will not assign final grades or make misconduct findings.
You control course-specific AI and assessment policies within institutional rules.
Students see clear source, policy, and limitation labels.
You will receive migration, accessibility, grading, and support help.
The pilot is designed to identify what should change before broader rollout.

Recommended sequence

1. Build the controls/evidence register and procurement room.
2. Complete a realistic HECVAT from actual evidence; do not treat it as certification.
3. Implement baseline security, privacy, accessibility, AI governance, and incident/recovery controls.
4. Adopt and test the relevant 1EdTech standards in a synthetic sandbox.
5. Conduct a gap assessment against TrustEd Apps privacy, security, and accessibility rubrics.
6. Publish accurate Trust Center documents only after technical/legal review.
7. Run a small, supported faculty pilot with low-risk workflows.
8. Use pilot evidence to improve implementation, then pursue relevant 1EdTech conformance/certification paths.

The most persuasive message to a university is not “Semester has every feature.” It is: **Semester reduces student friction while making faculty, IT, accessibility, security, and privacy teams more confident—not more exposed.**

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1. <https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit>
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